

Unit 3

Barriers to Communication

Pratik Shah

I – A

2026-2027

III	Barriers to Communication 3.1. Definition of Barrier 3.2. Types of barriers of communication Mechanical, Psychological, Linguistic, socio-cultural & Environmental etc. 3.3. Elimination / Removal of barrier
------------	--

3.1

Definition of Barrier

Definition of Barrier

Any obstacle or problem in the process of Communication which obstructs the process of Communication is called Barrier.

- Barriers are part of process of Communication.
- Whenever we are communicating we encode and decode.
- We use various channels for passing messages.
- At any level or at any moment or stage there can be problems in communication process.

- Sometimes the sender may not use proper language that the receiver will understand.
- Receiver may not be able to Decode properly.
- There can be lot of noise in the surrounding which can disturb us.
- It rarely happens that barriers do not arise in the communication process.
- Many times barriers arise in the minds of the sender and receiver.
- The intended messages are not sent to the receivers

- When we talk to others, we assume that others understand what we are saying because we know what we are saying.
- But this is not the case for audience.
- Usually people bring their own attitude, perception, emotions and thoughts about the topic and hence creates barrier in delivering the right meaning.

- We need to think from the point of receivers point of view.
- Would he understand the message?
- How will it sound on the other side of the table?

3.2

Types of barriers of communication: Mechanical, Psychological, Linguistic, socio-cultural & Environmental etc.

Linguistic Barriers

The language barrier is one of the main barriers that limit effective communication. Language is the most commonly employed tool of communication. The fact that each major region has its own language is one of the Barriers to effective communication.

Barriers arising due to the different language or differences in language can create problems in communication.

Semantic Barriers means the problems arising because of the different meanings of the words.

For example, a message that includes a lot of specialist jargon and abbreviations will not be understood by a receiver who is not familiar with the terminology used.



danger



clothes

10/02/2024



luck



衣服



2024/10/02

Psychological Barriers

There are various mental and psychological issues that may be barriers to effective communication. Some people have stage fear, speech disorders, phobia, depression etc. All of these conditions are very difficult to manage sometimes and will most certainly limit the ease of communication.

- **Perception**

- Retention filtering of things that feel good, and the tendency to forget those things that are painful.

- **Experiential Barriers**

- The difficulty in understanding things not personally experienced.

- **Emotions**

- Emotions influence both what is said and what is heard.

- **Defensiveness**

- Adjustments people make to avoid acknowledging personal inadequacies that might reduce their self-esteem.

Causes of Psychological Barrier



Suspicion and Prejudice



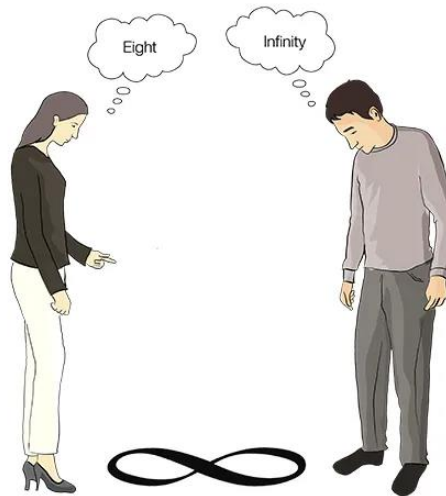
Defensiveness and Fear



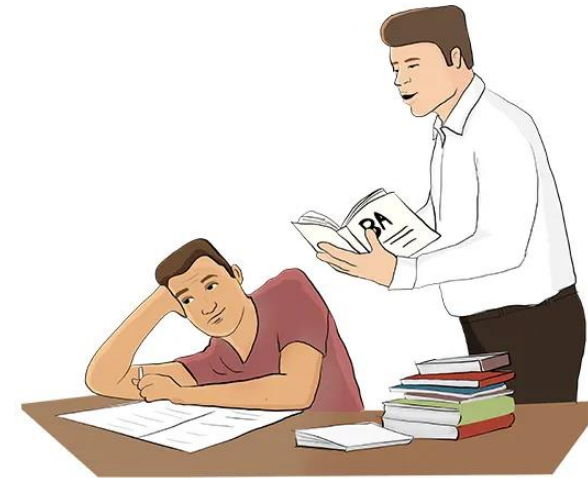
Resistance to Change



Emotional States



Selective Perception



Distraction and Inattentiveness

Emotional Barriers

The emotional IQ of a person determines the ease and comfort with which they can communicate. A person who is emotionally mature will be able to communicate effectively. On the other hand, people who let their emotions take over will face certain difficulties.

A perfect mixture of emotions and facts is necessary for effective communication. Emotions like anger, frustration, humour, can blur the decision-making capacities of a person and thus limit the effectiveness of their communication.



Mechanical Barriers

- Mechanical communication barriers are technical sources of interference in the communication process.
- A mechanical barrier stems from a problem in machinery or instruments used to transmit the message.
- This is not limited to media forms such as radio and television; it also includes machines used by those with hearing or speech impairments.
- Examples of mechanical communication barriers are noisy communication machines or instruments, absence of means of communication instruments, transmission interruption and power failure.



Physical Barriers to Communication

They are the most obvious barriers to effective communication. They include barriers like noise, closed doors, faulty equipment used for communication, closed cabins, etc.

An example of a physical barrier to communication is geographic distance between the sender and receiver

Cultural Barriers of Communication

As the world is getting more and more globalized, any large office may have people from several parts of the world.

Different cultures have a different meaning for several basic values of society.

Dressing, Religions or lack of them, food, drinks, pets, and the general behaviour will change drastically from one culture to another.

Hence it is a must that we must take these different cultures into account while communication. This is what we call being culturally appropriate.

In many multinational companies, special courses are offered at the orientation stages that let people know about other cultures and how to be courteous and tolerant of others.

Cultural Barriers to Communication



- **Examples of Cultural Barriers to Communication**
- **Language** - misunderstandings are common among people who speak the same language, so it's not surprising that people from different cultural and linguistic backgrounds face communication barriers.
- Anything from the mispronunciation of a word to a lack of specificity can lead to misunderstandings.
- For example, if a sales director in New York asks a contractor in Brazil to do something soon, the two parties may have a different interpretation of the word 'soon.'
- Language is a reflection of culture, and different cultures have very different ways of assigning meanings to words.

- **Behaviour** - cultural differences in body language and other behaviours can also cause miscommunications.
- **For example, in the U.S., it is important to make eye contact with someone who is speaking to you or they may think you are distracted or uninterested.**
- in many Asian countries, eye contact can be a sign of disrespect or a challenge to authority.
- There are many other cultural differences in body language that can create barriers to effective communication.
- Those include differences in facial expressions, the use of nodding to indicate agreement or understanding, and the amount of space to give someone with whom you are having a conversation.

Organizational Structure Barriers

As we saw there are many methods of communication at an organizational level. Each of these methods has its own problems and constraints that may become barriers to effective communication.

Most of these barriers arise because of misinformation or lack of appropriate transparency available to the employees.

Attitude Barriers

Certain people like to be left alone. They are the introverts or just people who are not very social. Others like to be social or sometimes extra clingy! Both these cases could become a barrier to communication. Some people have attitude issues, like huge ego and inconsiderate behaviours.

Perception Barriers

Different people perceive the same things differently. This is a fact which we must consider during the communication process. Knowledge of the perception levels of the audience is crucial to effective communication. All the messages or communicate must be easy and clear.

Physiological Barriers

Certain disorders or diseases or other limitations could also prevent effective communication between the various channels of an organization. The shrillness of voice, dyslexia, etc are some examples of physiological barriers to effective communication. However, these are not crucial because they can easily be compensated and removed.

Technological Barriers & Socio-religious Barriers

Other barriers include the technological barriers. The technology is developing fast and as a result, it becomes difficult to keep up with the newest developments. Hence sometimes the technological advance may become a barrier. In addition to this, the cost of technology is sometimes very high.

Most of the organizations will not be able to afford a decent tech for the purpose of communication. Hence, this becomes a very crucial barrier

Environmental Barriers To Communication

- Environmental barriers to communication are any part of the environment or surroundings that can prevent communication or getting in touch with another person or something else.
- There are a huge number of environmental barriers to communication.

Time/ Place/ Space/ Climate and Noise are the generally accepted barriers to communication.

- **Time:** Time lag and the amount of time it takes for a message to travel across the world is one of the most major barriers to communication and how things are communicated.
- Communication and the speed of communication is the most major factor.
- **Space:** The space in between the communications and the size of the area is also a major factor in the process of communication.
- Space can act as a barrier and an aid to communication

Climate : Warm weather or cold weather can cause affects on people's perceptions and their abilities to make decisions.

Different climates affect people's views in different ways and can be a barrier to communication caused by environment.

- **Place:** The place is also a factor that affects suitability of the communications on offer.
- **For example a place that has a bad environment and causes people to be irritable can cause people to lack in the communication end as they are unhappy.**
- In the opposite side of things a good environment can lead to calmer and better communication between people.



Environmental Barriers To Communication

3.3

Elimination/Removal of Barrier

- **Use of Simple Language:** Use of simple and clear words should be emphasized.
- Use of ambiguous words and jargons should be avoided.
- **Reduction and elimination of noise levels:** Noise is the main communication barrier which must be overcome on priority basis.
- It is essential to identify the source of noise and then eliminate that source.
- **Active Listening:** Listen attentively and carefully.
- There is a difference between “listening” and “hearing”.
- Active listening means hearing with proper understanding of the message that is heard.
- By asking questions the speaker can ensure whether his/her message is understood or not by the receiver in the same terms as intended by the speaker.

Clarify Ideas before Communication: The person sending the communication should be very clear in his mind about what he wants to say.

He should know the objective of his message and, therefore, he should arrange his thoughts in a proper order.

Communicate According to the Need of the Receiver:

The sender of the communication should prepare the structure of the message not according to his own level or ability but he should keep in mind the level, understanding or the environment of the receiver.

- Consult Others before Communication:

- At the time of planning the communication, suggestions should be invited from all the persons concerned.
- Its main advantage will be that all those people who are consulted at the time of preparing the communication plan will contribute to the success of the communication system.

- Be Aware of Language, Tone and Content of Message:

- The sender should take care of the fact that the message should be framed in clear and beautiful language. The tone of the message should not injure the feelings of the receiver. As far as possible the contents of the message should be brief and excessive use of technical words should be avoided.

- **Convey Things of Help and Value to the Listener:**

- The subject matter of the message should be helpful to the receiver. The need and interest of the receiver should specially be kept in mind. Communication is more effective in such a situation.

- **Ensure Proper Feedback:**

- The purpose of feedback is to find out whether the receiver has properly understood the meaning of the information received.
- In the face-to- face communication, the reaction on the face of the receiver can be understood.
- But in case of written communication or some other sort of communications some proper method of feedback should be adopted by the sender.

- Consistency of Message:

- The information sent to the receiver should not be self- contradictory. It should be in accordance with the objectives, policies, programmes and techniques of the organisation. When a new message has to be sent in place of the old one, it should always make a mention of the change otherwise it can create some doubts.

- Follow up Communication:

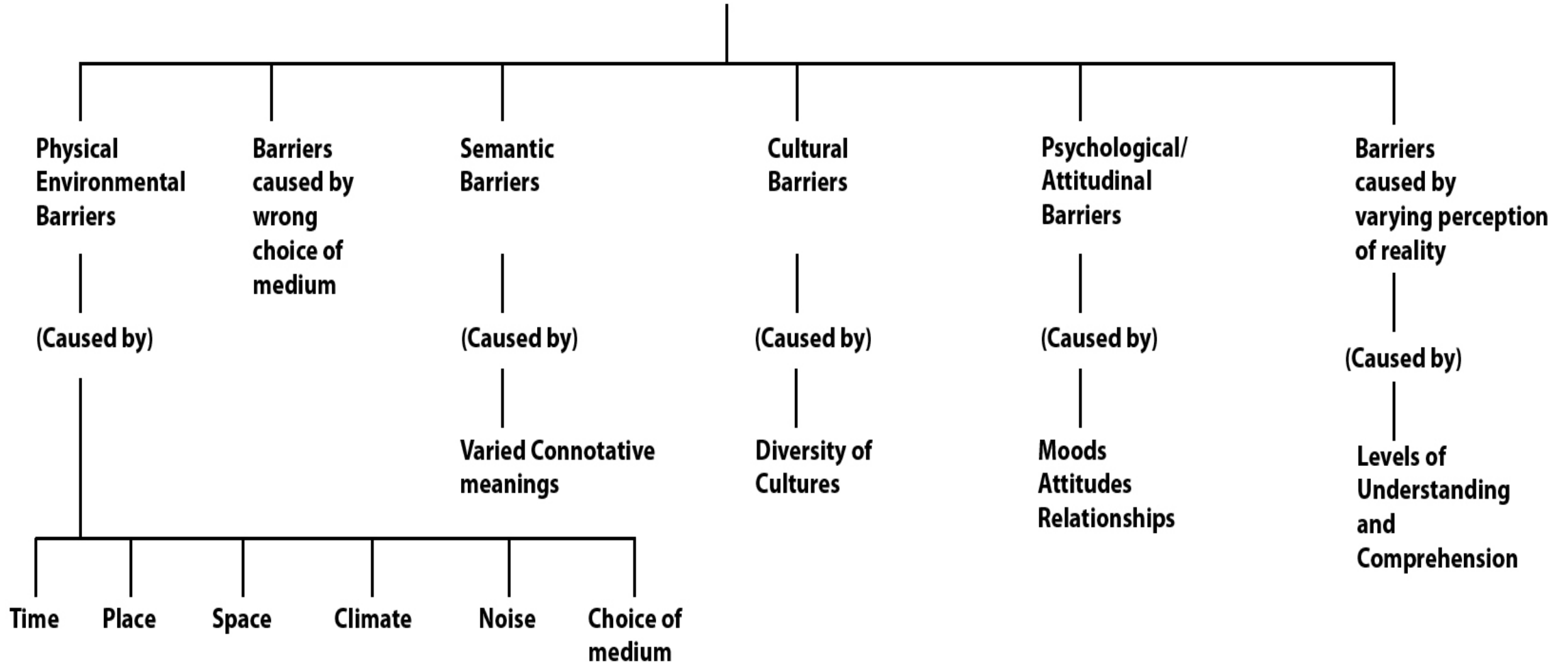
- In order to make communication effective the management should regularly try to know the weaknesses of the communication system. In this context effort can be made to know whether to lay more stress upon the formal or the informal communication would be appropriate.
- Similarly, suggestions can be invited in respect of the medium of communication (oral, written and gestural) to know as to which medium would be more effective and appropriate.

- Be a Good Listener:

- It is the essence of communication that both the sender and the receiver should be good listeners. Both should listen to the each other's point of view with attention, patience and positive attitude. A sender can receive much relevant information by being a good listener.

SUMMARY

Barriers to Communication



Identify the Barriers

A tourist in a foreign country struggling to ask for directions because they don't speak the local language

A colleague who doesn't trust another may refuse to share important information, even if the other person is asking for it

A malfunctioning microphone on a headset.

Online class participants unable to join due to outdated software

If you're trying to have a video call in a room with inadequate lighting, it can be difficult for the other person to see your facial expressions or body language

THANK YOU !!!!